Ford Motor Company

April 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 01S15: Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year SVT Mustang Cobra and Certain 2000 Model Year SVT Mustang Cobra R Vehicles – Rear Knuckle Replacement

REF #1: Dealer Announcement dated May 10, 1999: Low Volume Recalls and Owner Notification Programs

REF #2: Dealer Announcement dated December 17, 1998: Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 1999 and 2000 model year SVT Mustang Cobra and certain 2000 model year SVT Mustang Cobra R vehicles built at the Dearborn Assembly Plant from Job #1, 1999 through August 28, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

Under very aggressive driving cycles, the ball joint assembly in the rear suspension knuckle may be displaced out of its installed position in the knuckle boss potentially fracturing the knuckle. A fractured knuckle may cause the suspension to contact the rear wheel and affect steering control.

SERVICE ACTION

The dealer will replace both rear knuckle assemblies on all affected vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

LOW VOLUME RECALL

This recall is being processed as a Low Volume Recall. This type of field action was announced in an All Dealer letter dated May 10, 1999.

Owners will be contacting the Low Volume Recall Coordination Center to arrange for this service. We will advise you via MORS III of the owners that chose your dealership to perform the service provided by this Recall program. The parts will be ordered for you by the Program Coordination Center.

You are requested to contact the owner and arrange for this service. (Note that our Coordination Center will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days.)

SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure will be followed for the owners of these affected Mustang Cobra vehicles.

The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer these owners convenient vehicle handling.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Low Volume Dealer Announcement Letter
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure Announcement Letter
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:…….. 1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……. 1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 01S15
Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year SVT Mustang Cobra and
Certain 2000 Model Year SVT Mustang Cobra R Vehicles
Rear Knuckle Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

When you receive notification through MORS III, you should contact the owner and arrange for this service. Please note that our Coordination Center will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days. For more information, see Low Volume Announcement Letter dated May 10,1999.

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- To claim for the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of the Special Handling Procedure.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are approved per guidelines in "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling" procedure.

Safety Recall 01S15
Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year SVT Mustang Cobra and
Certain 2000 Model Year SVT Mustang Cobra R Vehicles
Rear Knuckle Replacement

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Replace both rear knuckle assemblies (includes wheel alignment)	01S15B	2.1 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling	Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"	See LCHP Announcement Letter

* Lincoln Commitment Special Handling does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will be shipped to your dealership according to the procedures established for "Low Volume Recalls". DO NOT order parts, except for dealer stock units.

Note: When the customer calls the Coordination Center, the correct parts will be automatically sent to the dealer. Parts not used may be returned for credit. (See "Excess Stock Return" below)

STOCK VEHICLES:

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Then, contact the Low Volume Recall Coordination Center at 1-800-248-0186 to arrange for parts. When calling this number, identify Safety Recall 01S15 and have the VIN of the dealer stock vehicle to be serviced.

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through order processing channels as noted below:

All Order Types	First 90 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
All Order Types	91 days after launch	Normal Order Process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
1R3Z-5B706-AA	Rear Knuckle Suspension Kit	1 per vehicle

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50231 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-248-0186).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

April 2001

01S15

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect that relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 1999 and 2000 model year SVT Mustang Cobra and certain 2000 model year SVT Mustang Cobra R vehicles.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that with your assistance we will correct this condition. Our commitment, together with Ford dealers, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the safety issue is…	Under very aggressive driving cycles, the ball joint assembly in the rear suspension knuckle may be displaced out of its installed position in the knuckle boss potentially fracturing the knuckle. A fractured knuckle may cause the suspension to contact the rear wheel and affect steering control.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do…	Ford Motor Company will replace both rear knuckle assemblies on your SVT Mustang Cobra or Cobra R free of charge.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.
Need a rental?	Your dealer is authorized to provide a rental vehicle at no charge (except for fuel) while your vehicle is at the dealership for repairs.

What we are asking you to do…

Call toll-free 1-800-248-0186 and inform the Ford representative that you wish to have your vehicle serviced under Safety Recall 01S15. Representatives are available 7:30AM to 7:30PM Monday through Friday, and 8:00AM to 3:00PM on Saturday (times are Eastern Time).

Please have this letter with you when you call. The Ford representative will ask for the serial number of your vehicle. The serial number is printed on the top of this letter.

Arrangements will be made with the dealership of your choice to have parts available. The dealership will call you to schedule an appointment. If you have not heard from your dealer within two working days, call your dealer to request a service appointment. You need do nothing else except bring your vehicle to the dealership on the service date.

If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you have already paid for this service…

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. However, for your safety, we still request that you return to your dealer to have these latest level parts installed on your vehicle. To receive a refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you have changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this recall.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager for assistance. If you still have concerns, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

Call (866) 436-7332 …

Hearing impaired, call (800) 232-5952 …

Office Hours: (Eastern Time Zone)

Monday-Friday:	8AM – 11PM
Saturday:	9PM – 6PM

TDD for the hearing impaired.

Or you may contact us through the Internet …

www.ownerconnection.com

Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline at 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we are here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs